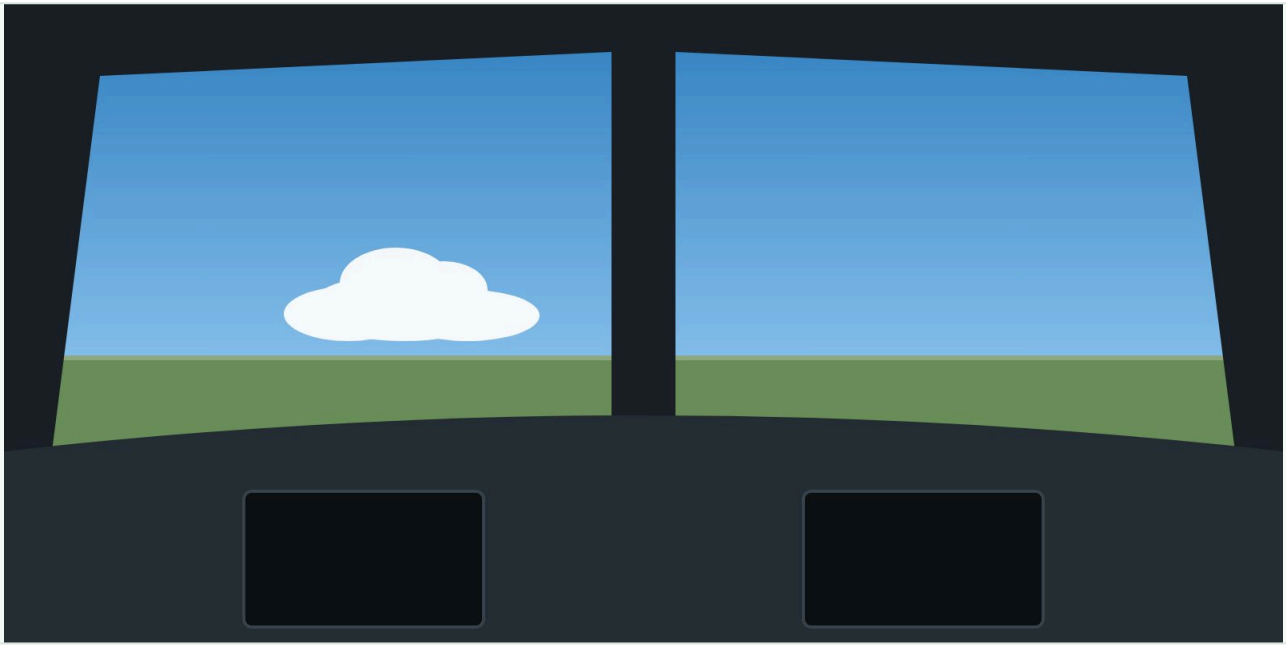
MODULE 1 · MEL PRINCIPLES

Lesson 02: Reading an MEL Item

Lesson 2 of 4 · about 7 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Read the columns and conditions of an MEL item.
- Apply the rectification interval categories.
- Apply (M) and (O) procedures and placards.



Read every column of the MEL item.

The columns

Column	Meaning
System / item (ATA chapter)	The equipment, by ATA reference (e.g. 28 fuel, 73 engine fuel and control)
Rectification interval category	The time allowed to repair the item (A, B, C or D)
Number installed	How many are fitted
Number required for dispatch	How many must work
Remarks or exceptions	The conditions, limitations and procedures for dispatch

Rectification interval categories

Category	Interval
A	No standard interval — as stated in the remarks of the item
B	3 consecutive calendar days, excluding the day of discovery

C	10 consecutive calendar days, excluding the day of discovery
D	120 consecutive calendar days, excluding the day of discovery

A one-time extension of categories B, C or D may be allowed under a procedure approved by the authority — never by the crew.

(M), (O) and placards

- **(M)** — a maintenance procedure must be performed before dispatch (e.g. deactivating or securing the item).
- **(O)** — an operational procedure must be applied by the crew (e.g. a performance penalty, a fuel requirement, a procedure in flight).
- The inoperative item must be **placarded** and recorded in the technical log.

EXAMPLE — B737-800 MEL 28-01-03-01 (FROM THE COMPANY LOFT)

(M)(O) One main tank aft boost pump may be inoperative provided that: (a) both main tank forward pumps operate normally; (b) at the start of take-off, fuel in the associated tank is not less than 7,500 lb (3,402 kg); (c) a minimum of 2,500 lb (1,134 kg) is maintained in the associated tank; and (d) the boost pump is deactivated. — Training example only; always use the current MEL.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Read every column: category, installed, required, remarks.
- Categories: A as stated, B 3 days, C 10 days, D 120 days (excluding day of discovery).
- (M) maintenance and (O) operational procedures; placard and log the item.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

What is the rectification interval for a category C item?

A. 3 days

B. 10 calendar days excluding the day of discovery

C. 120 days

D. As stated in the remarks

Answer: B. Category C: 10 consecutive calendar days, excluding the day of discovery.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.